

THE TRAJECTAS LEADERSHIP INDEX

Most leadership assessments measure **traits**.

We measure something more useful. Where, in the actual work of leadership, does this person create progress, and where do they create risk?

THE TRAJECTORY

Leadership has a recognisable shape.

Moving from ambiguity to responsible progress, in five phases.

1

Read

Read the situation.

2

Shape

Shape the problem.

3

Commit

Commit to a path.

4

Mobilise

Mobilise people and systems.

5

Advance

Advance through delivery and learning.

WHAT IT MEASURES

Ten capabilities. Five phases.

Each phase pairs an **active** capability (the work) with a **grounding** capability (the discipline that keeps the work honest).

READ	SHAPE	COMMIT	MOBILISE	ADVANCE
ACTIVE Strategic Inquiry	ACTIVE Problem Framing	ACTIVE Decision Quality	ACTIVE Operating Design	ACTIVE Delivery Discipline
GROUNDING Human Insight	GROUNDING Value Focus	GROUNDING Accountable Judgement	GROUNDING Relational Leadership	GROUNDING Adaptive Learning

WHY THE PAIRING MATTERS

Active without grounding goes wrong.

ACTIVE

Inquiry

Without people-orientation, becomes academic.

GROUNDING

Human Insight

Keeps inquiry rooted in real people, real work.

Deciding without accountability becomes recklessness.
Structuring without commitment becomes compliance theatre. Strong leadership requires both sides.

WHAT YOU GET

A 15-minute assessment. A practical diagnostic.

1

Capability scores

Where the leader is reliable, context-dependent, or at risk.

2

Phase trajectory

Which parts of the leadership cycle hold up and which break down.

3

Imbalance flags

Where the active and grounding capabilities are out of step. Often the most diagnostically interesting finding.

4

Archetypal pattern

Which of six recognisable leadership patterns the profile most closely resembles.

5

Development focus

Specific practices the leader can build to strengthen each capability.

WHY IT'S DIFFERENT

Built on how leadership works, not how leaders look.

Capability, not personality.

Every indicator is a developable practice. Coaching focuses on building specific routines, not on changing who someone is.

Process, not profile.

The trajectory diagnoses where leadership breaks (Read, Shape, Commit, Mobilise, or Advance) rather than producing a generic strengths map.

Grounded in research.

Over five decades of leadership and organisational psychology. Weick, Edmondson, Locke & Latham, Tetlock.

Designed for senior leadership.

Innovation is an outcome of the trajectory, not a standalone trait. AI-augmented leadership is built into the model, not bolted on.

WHAT IT'S FOR

Four primary uses.

- 01 Leadership development and coaching
- 02 Succession assessment and pipeline planning
- 03 Organisational leadership capability mapping
- 04 Executive search assessment, as one input among several

For high-stakes selection, the TLI is used **alongside structured interview and other inputs.**
Never alone.

THE LEADERSHIP TRAJECTORY

Read.
Shape.
Commit.
Mobilise.
Advance.

That is the leadership trajectory the Trajectas Leadership Index measures.

 FIND OUT MORE

Overview & Practitioner Guide. Technical Manual. Foundational Research. Available on request.